DIVISION II SECTIONAL WRESTLING

Sailors start strong, send five to semis

Hans Schneider
The Chronicle-Telegram

MEDINA — It's a sectional tournament with some local flavor to it.

The opening day of the Division II sectional wrestling tournament at Highland High ended with 15 area wrestlers still having a sectional title within their grasp. And while the general consensus was that things have gone according to plan, the local team with the most wrestlers still alive with a chance for a title might be a surprise — Vermilion.

The Sailors have five wrestlers in the semifinals and that was a pleasant surprise for coach Tony Budka.

"I'm pretty pleased with what we got right now," said Budka, whose team is in sixth place. "We have 103 (Alex West), 130 (Andrew Squires), 135 (Anthoney Budka), 145 (Ryan Shupe) and 160 (Ryan Kohl) still alive. Plus we still got other kids going in the consolation bracket.

"The one surprise of the five is probably Squires. He has really come on the past couple of weeks. It was like a light clicked on and he has really taken his wrestling to the next level."

As if having five wrestlers in the semifinals isn't enough to bring a smile to Budka, he has the added treat of one of the five being his freshman son Anthoney. However, the joy of his son advancing also brings the challenge of being both the coach and parent.

"Usually I don't sit in the chair when he wrestles so I don't put any added pressure on him," Budka said. "But, he asked me this week to start sitting in the chair."

"I think he deserves to sit in the chair," Anthoney said. "Personally, going to sectionals I have been looking forward to having him there. I grew up watching my dad coach and I wouldn't want him any other place than in that chair when it's my turn on the mat."

Right behind Vermilion are Avon and Elyria Catholic.

The Eagles — sitting seventh — have title hopes for Jake Saladonis (103), Nick DiFrancesco (125) and Alex Tabar (140).

"I think we're doing as expected," Eagles coach Joe Mauser said. "I don't think we won any that we should have lost or lost any that we should have won. We lost a tough one at 135 (Nate Russian). He beat the kid by one point last week, and lost (Friday night) by two.

"You always want to win the close ones but sometimes you don't."

EC — sitting eighth — has four wrestlers in the semifinals, although it could have been five had Trent Szente (160) not lost a heartbreaker.

"Tonight went well, as expected," EC coach Kent Horton said. "The one surprise was Trent. He was dominating the match and right at the end got thrown on his back. So that was a tough one to take.

"But, we still have 112 (Joey Cavaceci), 125 (Josh Taylor), 140 (Danny Accorti) and 171 (Dane Szente) going. Dane and Josh are looking really strong in their classes and I like where we are sitting."

Keystone sophomore Anthony Chizamadia, who placed fifth last year, moved into the semifinals with a 36-second pin of Brookside's Brett Harmon.

"Having the experience last year was a big help," Chizmadia said. "It gave me the confidence to go out there and let it fly. I know what to expect this time around."

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TEAM STANDINGS: Highland 105, Padua 71.5, Holy Name 69, Fairview 61.5, Rocky River 53, Vermilion 44, Avon 37, Elyria Catholic 36, Buckeye 31, Bay 22.5, Keystone 21, Brookside 19, Firelands 11.5.

QUARTERFINALS

103 — Jake Saladonis (A) dec. Tyler Geise (Bay), 2-1; Alex West (V) dec. Zack Hollo (RR), 4-3; Andrew Romanchik (P) maj. dec. James Brooks (HN), 9-0; Dan Mirman (H) tech. fall Alex Nelson (Fairview), 20-4. **112** — Bart Young (H) pinned Nick Barr (HN), 3:52; Anthony Feller (RR) pinned Justin Farrell (Fairview), 3:25; Joey Cavaceci (EC) dec. Joe Romano (P), 16-11; Carlton Wadkins (Buckeye) pinned Matt Koethe (V), 1:43. **119** — Jake Rininger (H) pinned Justin Gross (V), 1:35; Collan DaFonseca (P) pinned Matt Mahoney (RR), 4:33; Drew Liechty (Fairview) pinned Jake Thomas (Buckeye), :43; Nick Nelson (Bay) tech. fall Mike Pritt (Brookside), 16-0. **125** — Pat Mahoney (RR) pinned Jordan Smith (K), 4:39; Nick DiFrancesco (A) dec. Kyle Sharp (Bay), 7-2; Josh Taylor (EC) pinned Tim Birt (Fairview), 5:43; Steve DeSciscio (P) pinned Andrew Young (Buckeye), 1:36. **130** — Anthony Melillo (P) tech. fall Gage Riley (Buckeye), 15-0; Andrew Squires (V) pinned Tyler Lewis (A), 4:27; Doug Hayes (HN) tech. fall Matt Metzger (K), 17-0; Brad Kaplan (Fairview) pinned Jim Bede (H), 1:55. **135** — Logan Grescock (H) pinned Matt Sustar (P), 2:42; Anthoney Budka (V) dec. Nate Russian (A), 8-6; Matt Szucs (HN) pinned Kyle Nickel (Bay), 3:56; Brett Eppler (Fairview) pinned Alex Vandolov (Firelands), 1:47. **140** — Aaron Sulzer (HN) pinned Alex DiFranco (Fairview), :51; Alex Tabar (A) pinned Zach Novosielski (Firelands), 3:08; Danny Accorti (EC) maj. dec. James Gerken (K), 15-2; Jon McKee (H) pinned Anthony Kerwin (Buckeye), 1:50. **145** — Seamus Szcus (HN) pinned Tyler Bloniak (H), 1:56; Zack Lacure (Bay) dec. Alex Ross (K), 12-10; Paul Garcia (Firelands) pinned Eric Platt (P), 1:40; Ryan Shupe (V) Matt Mylechraine (A), 1:35. **152** — Corey Carlo (Fairview) pinned Mark Seifert (Bay), 1:34; Ryan Pischel (HN) dec. Tom Andrich (P), 3-2; Tucker Gregor (Buckeye) pinned Russell Lynch (RR), 3:42; Steve Timoteo (H) tech. fall Christian Perkins (K), 18-3. **160** — Riley Kilroy (P) pinned Kyle Miller (Buckeye), 2:44; Sam Crawford (Fairview) pinned Austin Tackett (Brookside), 1:30; Ryan Kohl (V) pinned Trent Szente (EC), 5:26; Ben Brown (H) pinned Cody Prewitt (K), 1:20. **171** — Dane Szente (EC) pinned Caanon Lorek (Fairview), 3:28; Andy Baker (P) dec. Mike Coleman (HN), 6-0; Nick Rados (Brookside) pinned Alex Phillips (H), 3:10; Mark Voll (RR) pinned Noah Pensinger (A), 1:38. **189** — Adam Voll (RR) dec. Vinnie Mannino (V), 4-1; Frank Wiancourt (HN) pinned Frank Baffa (Fairview), 3:10; Mark Gaydosh (P) pinned Nate Carson (EC), :42; Ted Bodnar (H) dec. Zac Maxworthy (Buckeye), 11-8. **215** — Tyler Houska (H) pinned Matt Kiessling (A), 4:07; Joe Gatto (P) pinned Jordan Kasper (Brookside), 1:28; Cody Carrow (Buckeye) pinned Zach Drews (EC), 2:31; Steve Shubeck (Fairview) dec. Harlen Page (Bay), 10-7. **HVY** — Matt Crowder (H) pinned Kris Horton (V), 4:35; Dale English (HN) pinned Danny Quallich (Buckeye), 1:33; Kevin Orris (RR) pinned Don Shumitsh (Fairview), :56; Anthony Chizmadia (K) pinned Brett Harmon (Brookside), :36.

SEMIFINAL PAIRINGS

103 — Saladonis vs. West; Romanchik vs. Mirman. **112** — Young vs. Feller; Cavaceci vs. Wadkins. **119** — Rininger vs. DaFonseca; Liechty vs. Nelson. **125** — Mahoney vs. DiFrancesco; Taylor vs. DeSciscio. **130** — Melillo vs. Squires; Hayes vs. Kaplan. **135** — Gresock vs. Budka; Szucs vs. Eppler. **140** — Sulzer vs. Tabar; Accorti vs. McKee. **145** — Szucs vs. Lacure; Garcia vs. Shupe. **152** — Carlo vs. Pischel; Gregor vs. Timoteo. **160** — Kilroy vs. Crawford; Kohl vs. Brown. **171** — Szente vs. Baker; Rados vs. Voll. **189** — Voll vs. Viancourt; Gaydosh vs. Bodnar. **215** — Houska vs. Gatto; Carrow vs. Shubeck. **HVY** — Crowder vs. English; Orris vs. Chizmadia.

DIVISION III SECTIONAL WRESTLING

Wellington still has hope

Matt Florjancic
The Chronicle-Telegram

BROOKLYN — One Wellington wrestler sported a T-shirt with a quote that was appropriate for their night: "Killing Time is Murdering Opportunity."

The Dukes jumped out to a quick start, but by the end of the first round Wellington found itself looking up at 10 other teams in the Division III sectional tournament at Brooklyn High on Friday night.

Sophomore 140-pounder Will Hall was the first Duke in competition. Hall used a mixture of takedowns and escapes to gain the advantage over Independence freshman Matt Ezzo. Late in the third period, Hall rolled Ezzo onto his back and earned three points for the near-fall. Those points proved to be the deciding factor for the sophomore, and Hall claimed the 9-7 victory.

Hall was one of the few wrestlers that had a pair of matches on Day 1. In the quarterfinals, Hall faced Clearview senior Jon Bill — a three-time district qualifier and the Patriot Athletic Conference's Wrestler of the Year.

Bill took Hall down early and scored the pinfall at 1:03.

The Dukes are in 11th place with 19 points, while Chanel (75.5) and Cuyahoga Heights (72) are in a tight race at the top of the standings with Clearview in third with 43.

"We could have been a little better," Wellington coach John Sedlick said. "We didn't have a real good draw. We had some tough guys right off the bat in the first round."

Though several Dukes fell on the first day, each remains in the hunt for a trip to the district tournament. Three Wellington wrestlers are still in line for a championship match.

Freshman 112-pounder Justin Bockmore (32-4) earned a bye in the quarterfinals and will face Rocco Columbo of Independence in the semifinals. Columbo registered a 12-4 major decision against Dave Vasquez of Cleveland Central Catholic.

Also in the hunt for sectional championships are 152-pound sophomore Austin Smith and Matt Ramage at 160 pounds. Smith and Ramage did not waste any time finishing their opponents. Smith dispatched Clearview's Jacob Champion in 3:39, while Ramage ran roughshod over Aron Sil of Lutheran West. Ramage earned a semifinal matchup with Chanel's Doug Fennell by pinning Sil in 37 seconds.

The Longhorns suffered seven losses in the first round, with the last being an unexpected setback. Heavyweight Ian Prah lost a decision to Cuyahoga Heights sophomore Daren Prater with a move late in the third period.

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TEAM STANDINGS: Chanel 75.50, Cuyahoga Heights 72, Clearview 43, Cleveland Central Catholic 37, Lutheran West 33, Oberlin 30, Independence 29.50, Trinity 29, Columbia 27, Brooklyn 20, Wellington 19, Open Door 0.

QUARTERFINALS

103 — No matches, all wrestlers had byes. **112** — Jimmy Mallos (CH) pinned Jeremy Walden (Chanel), 5:46; Anthony Johnson (O) pinned Lou Hetrick (B), :33; Rocco Columbo (I) major dec. Dave Vasquez (CCC), 12-4. **119** — Colin Dennis (LW) pinned Gary Bender (T), 1:37; Jimmy McManus (CH) pinned Josh Fralick (W), 4:53; William Vazquez (CCC) pinned Max Snow (Columbia), :39; Mike Kovach (Chanel) pinned Donnie Kuzilla (I), 1:13; Gary Bender def. Josh Fralick (W). **125** — Adam Bill (Clearview) pinned Devon McGee (T), :54; Danny Orrill (Chanel) pinned Mason Butler (Columbia), 2:54; Angelo Columbo (I) pinned Daniel Samkas (CCC), 1:10; Jimmy Dankle (CH) pinned Mike Chambers (LW), :51. **130** — Danny Collier (Chanel) pinned Eric Bednash (LW), 2:37; Gaby Voisin (I) pinned Matt Quinn (T), 3:47; Jeff Shaffer (Columbia) pinned Matthew Gerhardinger (O), :30. **135** — Josh Malave (LW) pinned Curtis Bittner (Columbia), 1:02; Kenny Trusnik (Chanel) pinned Jason Freas (O), 1:48; Ryan Wells (Clearview) pinned Mike Kline (B), 5:16; Zach Noernberg (CH) major dec. Sam Stretar (I), 11-1. **140** — Will Hall (W) dec. Matt Ezzo (I), 9-7; Robert Pajestka (CH) pinned C.D. Schneider (LW), 3:15; Steve Selage (Columbia) major dec. Antwaun Holley (T), 17-4; Jon Bill (Clearview) pinned Will Hall (W), 1:03; Andrew Schafer (Chanel) pinned Michael Palmer (O), :45. **145** — Erik Hatszegi (CCC) pinned Jose Soto (LW), 1:19; Jon Schafer (Chanel) tech. fall Zack-Mackulin (I), 15-0; Cody Kassnel (CH) pinned Brandon McGrigg (T), 1:07. **152** — Austin Smith (W) pinned Jacob Champion (Clearview), 3:39; Dan Dulik (I) tech. all Jordan Leslie (CCC), 18-3. **160** — Andrej Sessions (B) major dec. Gil Montague (I), 17-7; Doug Fennell (Chanel) pinned Randy Springborn (Clearview), 3:32; Matt Ramage (W) pinned Aron Sil (LW), :37. **171** — Seth Melvin (B) pinned Danny Lo (Clearview), :49; Steve Borowy (T) pinned Travis Beastrom (LW), 1:31; Andy Miller (O) pinned Justin Hamper (Columbia), 3:50; Ben Rosolowski (CH) pinned Mark Bennett (W), 2:57. **189** — Bill Barrett (Chanel) major dec. Cody Peacock (OD), 12-0; David Cooper (Clearview) pinned Tom Gronsky (W), 1:23; Bill Barrett (Chanel) pinned Julio Yachtayo (B), 3:03; Scott Kocevar (T) pinned Justin Braude (I), 1:50; Nick Chmura (O) major dec. Kyle Peters (CH), 18-4. **215** — Garry Yarborogh (T) dec. Greg Borowski (I), 4-0; Ethan Garofolo (Columbia) major dec. Josh Roberts (W), 16-2; Aaron Haynes (CCC) major dec. Tony D'Abato (OD), 15-6; Tom Elkaylany (CH) pinned Brandon Wille (Clearview), 1:48; Colin McHugh (LW) pinned Garry Yarborogh (T), 1:42. **HVY** — Mike McElligott (Chanel) pinned Jason Schramm (W), 1:54; Kenny Contreras (CCC) pinned Tom Starr (Clearview), 1:39; Daren Prater (CH) dec. Ian Prah (LW), 13-12; Matt Snyder (B) pinned John Mates (T), 3:33.

SEMIFINAL PAIRINGS

103 — Cody Tschantz (Chanel) vs. Steve Flury (LW); Erickson Andrews (O) vs. Max Klinger (CH). **112** — Mallos vs. Johnson; Justin Bockmore (W) vs. Columbo. **119** — Dennis vs. McManus; Vazquez vs. Kovach. **125** — A. Bill vs. Orrill; Columbo vs. Dankle. **130** — Collier vs. Voisin; Shaffer vs. Edwin Diaz (Clearview). **135** — Malave vs. Trusnik; Wells vs. Noernberg. **140** — Pajestka vs. Selage; J. Bill vs. Schafer. **145** — Hatszegi vs. Schafer; Ben Cline (Clearview) vs. Kassnel. **152** — Donald Pajestka (CH) vs. Smith; Cody Walters (Chanel) vs. Dulik. **160** — Fennell vs. Ramage. **171** — Melvin vs. Borowy; Miller vs. Rosclowski. **189** — Cooper vs. Barrett; Kocevar vs. Chmura. **215** — Garofolo vs. Haynes; Elkaylany vs. McHugh. **HVY** — McElligott vs. Contreras; Prater vs. Snyder.

SAINTS

From C1

"Mentally, (wrestling against St. Edward) can be intimidating," Amherst 119-pounder Josh Meade said. "But once you get on the mat, your instincts take over and they become just another team."

Meade was one of several area wrestlers to score a victory over St. Edward on Friday night. He pinned John Cobos, an Avon Lake resident and state qualifier, midway through the second period to advance to this afternoon's semifinals. Meade also scored a first-period pin over North Olmsted's Jake Rhinehelder in the opening round.

"Coming in I knew it was going to be tough," Meade said. "There's a lot of good kids at my weight class at this sectional. The pin (against Cobos) was a surprise. I honestly expected it to go all three periods. I knew I was in for a tough match against him."

St. Edward is still the obvious front-runner, but after the dominating performance the Eagles put up in the Saints gymnasium last year even a solid performance — the Eagles advanced 10 to the semifinals — feels like a bit of a letdown.

One Eagle who hasn't lost a thing from last season is two-time state champion Collin Palmer, who needed just nine seconds to pin North Ridgeville's Dominic Rogers in their 135-pound quarterfinal.

"I snapped him down and it was over," said Palmer, a junior who lives in Columbia Township. "There really wasn't much to it. I got a nine-second pin when I was younger but it's been awhile."

On the other side of Meade's bracket, Avon Lake sophomore Kevin Brunner was putting on a quick-pin clinic and he was doing it against some tough competition.

Brunner downed Admiral King's Juan Lugo in 52 seconds during the first round, then defeated Elyria's Kodie Egnor with a pin at 1:03 in the quarterfinals.

"I was really nervous going into that second match," Brunner said. "I wrestled (Egnor) last year and won 9-0, but he's been training with (Elyria coach Erik) Burnett and Steve Mitcheff over there, so he's obviously gotten a lot better."

The Day 1 performance has provided a bit of redemption for Brunner, who had a stellar 20-win freshman season ended by a two-and-out showing at sectionals.

"My season just fell apart," Brunner said. "I'm looking to make up for it this year. It'd be nice to get out (of sectionals) and win some matches at districts."

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TEAM STANDINGS: St. Edward 89.5, Southview 81, Elyria 75.5, Westlake 51, Amherst 49, Avon Lake 45.5, North Ridgeville 40, Olmsted Falls 38, Midview 34.5, Lakewood 25, North Olmsted 21, Admiral King 13.

QUARTERFINALS

103 — Uland Ralston (S) tech. fall Moe Rabah (W), 16-1; Rex Rozar (NR) dec. Kyle Sykes (M), 7-5; Evan Potts (AL) pinned P.J. Mueller (OF), 3:31; Gus Sako (SE) pinned Wes Foor (A), :40. **112** — Steve Mitcheff (E) pinned Tom DiMarino (NO), 1:06; Narcisco Inchaurregui (S) dec. Blake Jardonek (AL), 4-2; Connor Dempsey (W) maj. dec. Matt Zepp (NR), 15-4; Jamie Clark (SE) pinned Chris Gerhart (M), 1:00. **119** — Nick Lawrence (W) pinned Nate Hart (NR), 3:41; Kevin Brunner (AL) pinned Kodie Egnor (E), 1:03; Josh Meade (A) pinned John Cobos (SE), 3:31; David Gyorfi (S) tech. fall Joe Hough (OF), 15-0. **125** — Mike Varga (OF) pinned Jon Kirallah (NO), 1:07; Danny Urbin (AL) dec. Anthony Salupo (SE), 6-0; Zeno Inchaurregui (S) pinned John Whipkey (NR), :51; Austin DeChant (E) pinned Kevin Pierce (W), 2:41. **130** — Nick Sulzer (SE) tech. fall Adrian Marcial (S), 19-2; Naseem Merhi (W) dec. Nick Ramsey (AK), 8-5; Brandon Morgan (A) pinned Mike Gessner (NO), 4:57; Dalton McHenry (E) maj. dec. Jared Wise (M), 10-0. **135** — Collin Palmer (SE) pinned Dominic Rogers (NR), :09; Chaz McGrain (OF) dec. Mike Daniels (AK), 5-3; Brandon Perrott (E) tech. fall Sheldon Stuckart (NO), 16-0; Pat Duffy (L) maj. dec. Derek Zimmerman (A), 16-2. **140** — Neil Birt (SE) pinned Sean Escolas (W), 4:26; Tony Scilmenti (AK) dec. Cody Dieckman (OF), 3-0; Tony Martinez (S) maj. dec. Alex Baslnski (A), 14-5; Chase Churchill (E) pinned Adam Davis (M), 1:15. **145** — Bobby Cruz (S) pinned J.D. Hackman (W), 1:46; Connor Suba (SE) pinned Thaer Zayed (NO), :18; Ramon Castoneda (A) dec. Peti Tapolyal (L), 3-0; Phillip Egnor (E) maj. dec. Matt Phillips (NR), 10-2. **152** — Zack Goins (E) pinned Josh Parker (S), 3:05; Sean Pincura (M) pinned Alex Feador (NO), 2:22; Cory Martinson (SE) pinned Jeremy George (AL), 1:45; Devin Henry (W) pinned James Mees (NR), 3:16. **160** — Mark Tomanek (AL) tech. fall Brad Spreng (W), 20-5; Paul Findley (S) dec. Jordan Smith (M), 8-6; Chris Kelly (NO) pinned Vinny Fox (L), 4:27; Derek Lozano (NR) dec. Jason Gott (E), 3-2. **171** — Brian Roddy (SE) pinned Jeff Pye (AK), :16; Shane Friend (NR) dec. Ben Kovach (AL), 7-2; Jose Martinez (S) pinned Mitchell Fadenholz (E), 1:08; Aaron Winemiller (A) dec. John Dever (W), 8-1. **189** — Ryan Nellase (E) pinned John Flesher (NR), :29; Brandon Dean (M) pinned Dustin English (S), 5:08; Nate Rychlik (SE) dec. Justin Stump (A), 5-3 (OT); Joe Goff (OF) dec. Gabe Wiles (NO), 6-4. **215** — Ryan Smugala (W) pinned Matt Cadrette (A), 3:38; Mike Green (SE) dec. Jerry Knapp (OF), 5-3; Gahad Suleiman (AK) maj. dec. Jack Motyka (NR), 15-7; Nick Santana (S) dec. Caleb Borden (AK), 4-2. **HVY** — Greg Byrd (NR) pinned Marlowe Burton (S), 5:02; Andrew Brumenschenkel (A) dec. Adrian Adams (E), 3-1; Quentin Watson (AK) pinned Patrick Flesher (AL), 2:57; Zach Laird (OF) maj. dec. Mark Horton (SE), 15-5.

SEMIFINAL PAIRINGS

103 — Ralston vs. Rozar; Potts vs. Sako. **112** — Mitcheff vs. N. Inchaurregui; Dempsey vs. Clark. **119** — Lawrence vs. Brunner; Meade vs. Gyorfi. **125** — Varga vs. Urbin; Z. Inchaurregui vs. DeChant. **130** — Sulzer vs. Merhi; Morgan vs. McHenry. **135** — Palmer vs. McGrain; Perrott vs. Duffy. **140** — Birt vs. Scilmenti; Martinez vs. Churchill. **145** — Cruz vs. Suba; Castoneda vs. Egnor. **152** — Goins vs. Pincura; Martinson vs. Henry. **160** — Tomanek vs. Findley; Kelly vs. Lozano. **171** — Roddy vs. Friend; Martinez vs. Winemiller. **189** — Nellsse vs. Dean; Rychlik vs. Goff. **215** — Smugala vs. Green; Suleiman vs. Santana. **HVY** — Byrd vs. Brumenschenkel; Watson vs. Laird.

ELYRIA

From C1

"If you can't make a shot and you turn the ball over and you're on the road against a good team," Brunswick coach Joe Mackey said, "it's hard to win. They did a nice job on Tyler (Ferrell), obviously, but in that situation, you kind of need somebody else to step up. I thought we had some good looks at the basket — especially in the third quarter — but we never took advantage of it."

Brunswick only scored three points in the third quarter — a 3-pointer by Bob Ritchie with 2:48 left in the quarter. The Blue Devils misfired on all six attempts to that point and on a pair of free throws to boot. Elyria's lightning-quick guards helped cause five turnovers, but the Pioneers only scored six points themselves and led just 32-31 entering the final quarter.

"It was our last game here," senior point guard Promis Cabbil said. "We knew we had to turn it up."

Ferrell had 10 points in the first half with a strong effort inside. He added just a pair of free throws in the second and was held to only two shots. Joe Puch scored all 13 of his total in the first half. Brunswick made just three field goals after intermission on 17 attempts.

"When they got it down to (Tyler) Ferrell on the block, he was surrounded by people," Walsh said. "(Our kids) just did a heck of a job helping each other out — especially with Ferrell. This is the way a team plays together — offense and defense."

The backbreaker came on a sequence with just under five minutes to play and Elyria ahead 39-34. Ritchie's 3-point attempt rimmed out and was grabbed by Ferrell underneath, but before he had a chance to do anything with it, Cabbil slapped it away.

Cabbil came up with the ball in the scramble and passed ahead to Demetrius Dalton at the far right baseline beyond the 3-point arc. Dalton's shot barely wrinkled the cords, giving Elyria an eight-point lead and taking the wind out of the Blue Devils.

"When they got the rebound," Cabbil said, "luckily I got the steal and kicked it ahead to Putt (Dalton's nickname) to hit the three. He's got no conscious, so he shot it."

"Coach Walsh just told me to be confident with my shot and take my time," Dalton said. "I kept my confidence, threw it up there and it went in."

"We were getting loose balls and creating opportunities," Walsh said.

Dalton scored 17 points, Cabbil added 15 and Travis Noble 10, but Elyria had to overcome three quick fouls on its tallest player — 6-foot-4 senior Seryrell Davis with 5:23 remaining in the first quarter. With Davis on the bench, Walsh was concerned.

"He's sitting on the bench beside me," Walsh said. "We're in trouble. But big Myke (Williams) came through and did a pretty solid job and Promis is our catalyst. Everything goes through Promis. We expect a lot out of him and he gives us a lot."

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Elyria 54, Brunswick 39

BRUNSWICK (39): Bob Ritchie 3-0-9, Jassen Kavedzic 0-0-0, Joe Puch 3-6-13, Tyler Ferrell 5-2-12, Ryan Pokorny 0-0-0, Bill Slattery 1-0-2, Dan Kissling 0-0-0, Adam Bernard 1-0-2, Dave Dynia 0-0-0, Brett Maloney 0-0-0, Kyle Payne 0-0-0, Alex Lukic 0-1-1. **Totals 13-9-39.**

ELYRIA (54): Promis Cabbil 5-3-15, Demetrius Dalton 5-5-17, Rayshawn Camel 2-2-6, Seryrell Davis 1-0-2, Travis Noble 4-0-10, Mykel Williams 2-0-4, John Yeaples 0-0-0, Alex McKenna 0-0-0, Michael Higginbotham 0-0-0, Kare King 0-0-0, DeSean Davis 0-0-0, Mike Cannon-Wohlever 0-0-0, Matt Velasquez 0-0-0. **Totals 19-10-54.**

Brunswick	10	18	3	8	—	39
Elyria	13	13	6	22	—	54

Three-point goals: Brunswick 4-14 (Ritchie 3, Puch), Elyria 6-13 (Cabbil 2, Dalton 2, Noble 2). **Field goals:** Brunswick 13-35 (37 percent), Elyria 19-48 (39.5 percent). **Free throws:** Brunswick 9-18 (50 percent), Elyria 10-13 (77 percent). **Rebounds:** Brunswick 30 (Ferrell 8), Elyria 29 (Cabbil, Noble 6). **Turnovers:** Brunswick 18, Elyria 10. **Fouls:** Brunswick 10, Elyria 17. **Fouled out:** None. **Technical foul:** Brunswick bench. **Junior varsity:** Brunswick 38-35.

'DOGS

From C1

North Olmsted, the consensus preseason SWC favorite, was denied its first conference title since 1973 — and it hurt.

"It's a devastating loss," said Eagles coach Tim Schmotzer. "I thought our guys put their whole heart into it. We played on (Olmsted Falls') floor and we were certainly in a position to win the game. I'm very proud of our guys. It's just a shame we couldn't take that next step and win a conference championship."

Both teams entered the fray with identical 11-2 conference records and riding seven-game winning streaks.

They mirrored each other in the final head-to-head matchup as well, with the game featuring 15 lead changes and nine ties, and neither team owning more than a six-point lead. The lead changed twice and was tied three times in the final quarter — a far cry from the outcome of the first meeting, which Falls won by 17 points at North Olmsted.

"It was very exciting," said Donahue, whose team ended the regular season 13-7 overall, with the Eagles finishing at 15-5. "You couldn't ask for a closer score or a closer game."

Both teams were forced to play without their leading scorers during the opening half — Olmsted Falls, without Pat Pellerite, who drew his second offensive foul with 4:38 left in the opening quarter and did not return for the rest of the half — and North Olmsted without Chris Arlinghaus and Kevin Kilbane, both getting whistled for their second fouls as well.

"That game could have been over very easily with Pat on the bench," said Donahue of his senior forward who entered the night as one of the area's leading scorers at 21.5 points per game. "The good thing is that we've been in that situation before. These guys hold down the fort until Pat's able to come back."

No one protected the turf better than the Bulldogs' senior guard Jim Brabenec, who scored nine of his game-high 25 points in the first 16 minutes. Brabenec and junior guard Scott Kimmey, who also scored nine first-half points, helped Falls keep it close before heading to the locker room trailing 29-28.

Pellerite returned to score 19 of his 21 points, but the Eagles didn't get their usual production from Kilbane and Arlinghaus, double-digit scorers who combined for just 17 points. Arlinghaus didn't attempt a shot in the opening half, scoring six points on a pair of second-half 3-pointers, while Kilbane scored just two points before intermission.

But like Falls, North Olmsted had reinforcements — none bigger than pivotman Pat Hanrahan.

The senior, who looks more like a football player in the trenches, was at home on the hardwood, scoring 16 points (well above his average), while controlling the paint with a whopping 22 rebounds that helped the Eagles to a 41-24 edge on the boards.

"That was his best game of the season," Schmotzer said. "The guy hasn't looked to score as much as we'd like, but he just came to play for us. I was very proud of a senior like that coming through like he did."

It appeared it might be a feel-good story for North Olmsted when Arlinghaus opened the final quarter with a 3-pointer that put the Eagles up 52-50. A 3-pointer from Dave Hall, followed by a steal and layup from Matt Roman left North in front 60-55 with 4:31 to play.

But Falls, not surprisingly, came back again, catching the Eagles at 65 on a 3-pointer from Kimmey with 2:24 left.

What followed was a microcosm of the entire night, with the two teams going back and forth before the Bulldogs forged ahead for good at 68-67 on Pellerite's old-fashioned three-point play with 1:37 to play.

A pair of free throws from Kimmey put Falls up 70-67 with 54 seconds remaining, with Roman missing a layup but getting fouled and splitting the foul shots to leave the Eagles trailing by two.

Two more foul shots from Pellerite gave the Bulldogs a 72-68 advantage with 28 seconds, but an Arlinghaus 3-pointer closed the gap to a point with 14 seconds left. Kimmey split a pair from the line to give the Eagles a chance to tie on two free throws from Kilbane with four seconds remaining.

But with the hometown crowd at a fever pitch, Kilbane missed the first foul shot and drew a violation after failing to catch the rim on an intentional miss.

A Kimmey free throw put Falls up by the final count, but there was one anxious moment left for the Bulldogs, who watched as Kilbane's half-court heave hit the front of the rim and fell to the floor as the final horn sounded, completing an improbable quest for another SWC title in Olmsted Township.

"We knew we were going to do it," said Brabenec, one of just four seniors on the Bulldog roster. "We had everything there. We just had to get through our inexperience and come through."

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Olmsted Falls 74, North Olmsted 71

NORTH OLMSTED (71): Matt Roman 5-1-12, Nick Brown 3-1-7, Dave Hall 2-0-6, Kevin Kilbane 4-3-11, George Bloomfield 3-0-7, Chris Arlinghaus 2-0-6, Cory Benkowski 2-0-4, Pat Hanrahan 5-6-16, Doug Otter 0-2-2, Cameron Burson 0-0-0. **Totals 26-13-71.**

OLMSTED FALLS (74): Tony Lanza 1-0-3, Scott Kimmey 4-8-18, John Atkinson 0-0-0, Mark Hurrell 1-1-3, Brandon Russo 0-0-0, Jim Brabenec 10-2-25, Steve Battaglia 1-2-4, Pat Pellerite 6-5-21, Orlando Glenn 0-0-0, Mike Abraham 0-0-0. **Totals 25-18-74.**

North Olmsted	14	15	20	22	—	71
Olmsted Falls	13	15	22	24	—	74

Three-point goals: Olmsted Falls 6-21 (Brabenec 3, Kimmey 2, Lanza); North Olmsted 6-21 (Hall 2, Arlinghaus 2, Bloomfield, Roman). **Field goals:** Olmsted Falls 25-51 (49 percent), North Olmsted 26-56 (46 percent). **Free throws:** Olmsted Falls 18-34 (53 percent), North Olmsted 13-21 (62 percent). **Rebounds:** Olmsted Falls 24 (Kimmey, Pellerite 6), North Olmsted 41 (Hanrahan 22). **Turnovers:** Olmsted Falls 6, North Olmsted 11. **Fouls:** Olmsted Falls 18, North Olmsted 26. **Fouled out:** Roman. **Junior varsity:** Olmsted Falls, 61-50.